

Tax structure, lack of incentives impact electronics manufacturing

Consumer Electronics and Appliances Manufacturers Association (CEAMA) has released a statement that the inverted duty structure and lack of incentives are impacting the manufacturing of consumer electronics. According to reports, in a letter to Ministry of Commerce and Industry, CEAMA has said that the tax structure on imports of parts and components to manufacture a product attracts huge customs and excise duties. This inverted duty structure impacts the domestic industry adversely as manufacturers have to pay a higher price for raw materials because of the duty, while importers are able to bring in the finished product by paying lower duty, which therefore costs less.

Currently, India is importing electronic goods worth US\$ 100 billion a year and the import bill is likely to cross US\$ 400 billion by 2020.

Hero Group enters electronics

Indian motorcycle and scooter manufacturer, Hero Group, has entered the electronics sector. The Delhi based two-wheeler manufacturer has launched a new company, Hero Electronix. To take this further, Hero will acquire a majority stake in Mybox, which is a multi-operator manufacturer of set-top boxes in the country.

Mybox is known for the set-top boxes it makes for various DTH operators in India. As Mybox is a known player in the cable and DTH broadcast system, Hero will get a strong foothold in the electronics ecosystem.

SoftBank to invest US\$ 20 billion in Indian solar projects

Japanese multinational telecommunications and Internet giant, SoftBank Corp., is partnering with India's Bharti Enterprises and Taiwan based

Management changes at LG India

South Korean electronics company LG has appointed Kim Ki-Wan to head its Indian operations. Soon Kwon will take over as global head for information display business, while former global head of marketing MY Kim replaces Kwon as managing director.

Ashraf ElArman named managing director of Xerox India

Xerox has announced the appointment of Ashraf ElArman as MD of its Indian unit. In this role, he will be responsible for new business development, driving growth and achieving business objectives for Xerox India.

Rupa Santosh to head Nokia Networks' Technology Center

Nokia has appointed Rupa Santosh as the head of Nokia Networks' Technology Centre in Bengaluru. The tech centre

electronics contract manufacturing company Foxconn. SoftBank will invest about US\$ 20 billion in solar projects in India. As India is looking to boost its renewable energy sector, SoftBank seeks business expansion in the same sector. SoftBank will initially invest US\$ 10 billion in India.

The three companies are committed to generating a minimum of 20GW of energy. Foxconn will provide support in solar equipment manufacturing for the projects. The companies are also looking at manufacturing equipment in India.

Major changes have been observed in the Indian solar industry. The rapidly-falling cost of solar power, which is expected to reach parity with conventional energy by 2017, has ignited interest in its potential in India.

Sony to tap rural TV market with small-screen units

Electronics major Sony aims to tap non-metro/rural markets with its small-screen television panels along

with strengthening its sales network in these areas.

Amit Pradhan joins Vodafone as Chief Technology Security Officer

Vodafone India, India's second-largest telecom operator, has appointed Amit Pradhan as chief technology security officer of the company. Prior to Vodafone India, Pradhan served Cipla for almost three years as group chief information security officer.

Sistema Shyam TeleServices announces two appointments

Sistema Shyam TeleServices (SSTL), which provides telecom services under MTS brand, has announced two senior leadership appointments. Bijender Yadav has been named chief technology officer and Ashok Singh has been named chief operating officer of Kolkata and West Bengal circles.

with strengthening its sales network in these areas.

The company, which launched an affordable range of television panels last year in order to tap tier II, III and IV markets, has expanded its sales network to over 10,000 distributors to cash in on the opportunities.

Eon Electric gets ₹ 510 million order for LEDs in UP, Rajasthan

LED lights manufacturer Eon Electric has won ₹ 510 million worth of contracts to supply LED streetlights in Aligarh in Uttar Pradesh and Jodhpur in Rajasthan.

With government's emphasis on conserving energy by replacing conventional lights by LED lights, the demand for LED streetlights in India is expected to reach ₹ 3950 billion by 2020. Accordingly, EON has expanded its portfolio from conventional/CFL lights to a range of LED bulbs and LED streetlights.

The company will install 60,000 LED streetlights in Jodhpur and